

travel, work, study or content creation. Everything else can live in the app drawer.

Remove first, organise later. Long-press an icon and choose Remove or drag it away from the home screen. Removing an icon does not usually uninstall the app; it only removes the shortcut from the screen. That distinction matters. You are not deleting your digital life. You are clearing the table.



Step-by-step: clean your current home screen

- Long-press any app icon you do not use daily.
- Choose Remove from Home or drag it to the remove area, depending on your phone.
- Repeat this for shopping apps, games, old launchers, duplicate browsers, unused payment apps and manufacturer promotions.
- Swipe to the next home screen and repeat.
- Delete empty folders.
- Remove widgets you have not looked at in the past week.
- Keep only the apps and widgets you use frequently or urgently.

After this, your phone may look strangely empty. Good. Empty is not the enemy. Empty gives you room to design.

Build one primary screen

Your first home screen should contain only the essentials. Think of it as the phone's cockpit. The most important icons should be reachable with one hand. On a large phone, that usually means the lower half of the screen. Do not place your most-used apps at the top just because the grid begins there. Your thumb has geography. Respect it.

A sensible primary screen for many Indian users could include Phone, Messages, WhatsApp, Camera, Browser, Maps, UPI app, Notes, Calendar and a search bar. But do not copy this blindly. A student may want Classroom, Docs and Drive. A creator may want Camera, Gallery, Instagram, editing app and voice recorder. A journalist may want recorder, notes, camera, email, browser and messaging apps. A shop owner may want WhatsApp Business, payments, calculator, inventory and delivery apps.

There is no universal perfect home screen. There is only a home screen that matches your day.

Use folders sparingly

Folders are useful until they become excuses. One folder called Money with banking, UPI, wallet, card and expense apps is useful. A folder called Apps containing 34 unrelated icons is surrender.

Good folders are action-based. Use names like Money, Work, Travel, Create, Study, Home, Health or Shop. Avoid vague names like Tools, unless the tools genuinely belong together. Even then, ask whether those apps need to be on the home screen at all.

Keep folders in the bottom half if you open them often. Put less urgent folders on the secondary screen. Do not put critical apps inside deep folders if you need them during stress. When the delivery person is waiting, when the cab driver is calling, when the UPI QR code is fading in bright sunlight, you do not want to play treasure hunt.

Widgets: glance, don't decorate

Widgets are one of Android's great advantages. They let apps show useful information or controls without forcing you to open the full app. But a widget earns its place only if it saves time or prevents forgetfulness.

Useful widgets include calendar agenda, weather, Keep notes, Tasks, battery, screen time, music controls, smart home controls, search, travel information and selected communication shortcuts. Google's Android help specifically notes that widgets can be added by long-pressing an empty home-screen area, opening Widgets, choosing the app and placing the widget.

A calendar widget can save you from missing a meeting. A weather widget can help before a commute. A notes widget can keep your shopping list visible. A battery widget can show ear-

